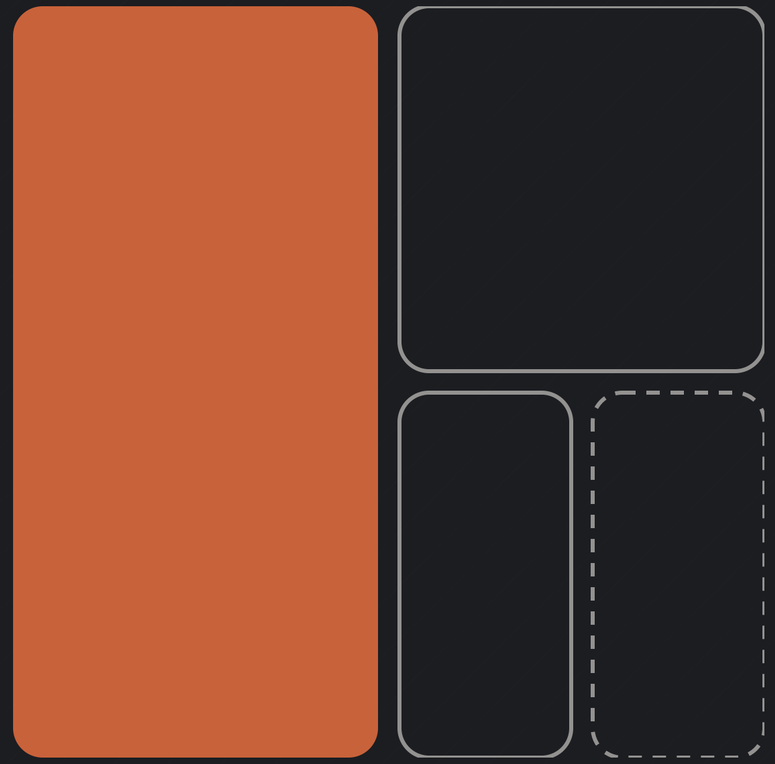
A MENU BAR APP FOR MACOS · V0.3

# Tiler

## Tiling windows, *one desktop at a time.*



Turn it on where you want order. Every other desktop and display stays exactly as you left it.

BikS2013

User guide · for Mac power users

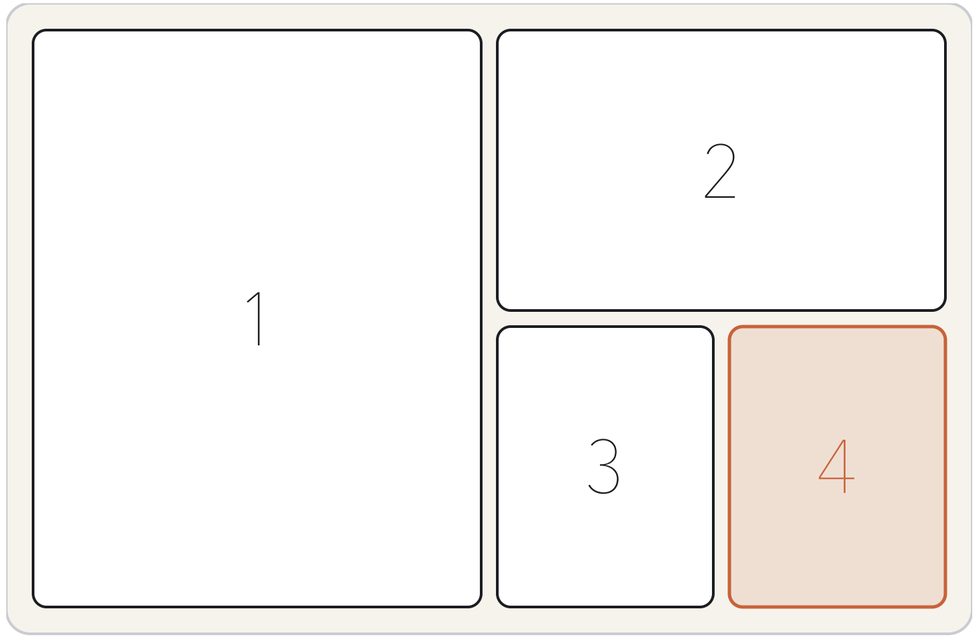
github.com/BikS2013/tiler

# A tiling window manager that lives in your menu bar.

Tiler arranges the windows of a desktop so they share the screen with no overlap and no wasted space. Each new window splits the one you were working in, along its longer side (a **dwindle** layout, as in Hyprland).

It works on **one desktop of one display at a time**, and only where you switch it on. Your other Spaces, your other screens and full-screen apps are never touched.

You keep using native macOS Spaces and Mission Control. Tiler just keeps the desktop you chose in order.




1 window fills the desktop. Window 2 splits it side by side; 3 splits 2 top and bottom; 4 splits 3 again, and so on.

**Gaps: 8 pt between windows and around the edges.**

# For Mac users who want order on some desktops, not all of them.

01

## Keyboard-first people

Developers, writers, analysts who live in a few windows side by side and would rather press a key than drag a corner.

Focus, swap and resize without the mouse.

02

## A tiled workspace, a free one

Tile your coding or research desktop; keep a loose desktop for mail, chat and the odd floating window.

Each desktop is a separate choice.

03

## Several displays

Tile the laptop screen while the external monitor stays freeform, or the other way round.

Tiler never moves a window on a screen you didn't turn on.

Not for you if you want every window on every desktop tiled automatically, or virtual workspaces that replace macOS Spaces.

# Simple on purpose: fewer moving parts, fewer surprises.

0%

CPU while you work. Tiler only wakes up when a window opens, closes or moves, and goes fully idle on desktops that aren't tiled.

| | |
|---|---|
| Polling | **none: it reacts to window events** |
| Keyboard interception | **none: system hotkeys only** |
| Virtual workspaces | **none: native Spaces** |
| Permissions | **Accessibility only** |
| Cost of one update | `≈ 1 ms` |
| Size of the code | `~3,300 lines` |

Measured on macOS 27 with two tiled desktops. Inspired by HyprMac (~35,000 lines), minus its workspaces, keyboard tap and polling.

01

# Get started.

Install with Homebrew, allow Accessibility once, then switch tiling on for the desktops you choose.

# Two commands, one permission.

```
$ brew tap BikS2013/tiler
$ brew install --cask tiler

# update later: brew upgrade --cask tiler
```

No Homebrew? Download `Tiler-0.3.0.zip` or the `.dmg` from **github.com/BikS2013/tiler/releases** and drag Tiler to Applications.

| | |
|---|---|
| Signed | **Developer ID, notarized by Apple** |
| Runs on | **Apple silicon and Intel** |
| Requires | **macOS 14 Sonoma or later** |
| Dock icon | **none: menu bar only** |

## First launch

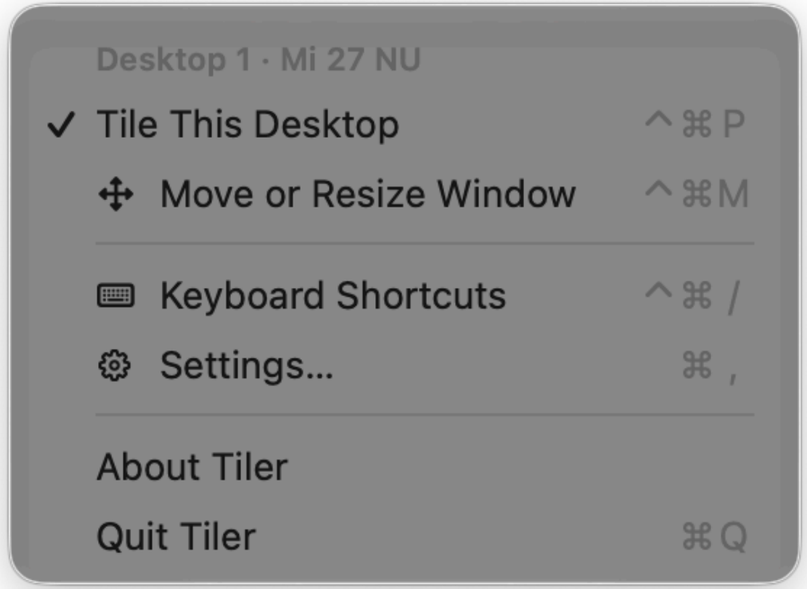
macOS asks for **Accessibility**: System Settings › Privacy & Security › Accessibility › enable Tiler. That's the only permission: no Input Monitoring, no Screen Recording.

# Tiling is a switch per desktop, per display.

01 **Menu bar:** click the Tiler icon on the screen you want and choose **Tile This Desktop**. It acts on the display whose menu bar you clicked.

02 **Keyboard:** press ⌃ ⌘ P on the display you're working on (the one with the focused window).

03 **Off:** the same item or key again. Windows simply stay where they are; Tiler stops all work there.




- Remembered across restarts and logins.
- The icon is filled when the current desktop is tiled.
- Full-screen Spaces can't be tiled.
- **Move or Resize Window** ( ⌃ ⌘ M ) lives here too.

02

# Everyday use.

Shortcuts for focus, swap, resize and layout; a cheat sheet one key away; keyboard moves for untiled windows; and the mouse when it's quicker.

# Every shortcut on one slide.

### GENERAL · WORK EVERYWHERE

| | |
|---|---|
| Tile or untile this desktop | ⌃ ⌘ P |
| Show keyboard shortcuts | ⌃ ⌘ / |
| Move or resize an untiled window | ⌃ ⌘ M |

### MOVE AROUND

| | |
|---|---|
| Focus the neighbouring window | ⌃ ⌘ + ← → ↑ ↓ |
| Swap with the neighbour | ⌃ ⇧ ⌘ + ← → ↑ ↓ |

All but the three General shortcuts exist only while a tiled desktop has focus, so the same keys keep working in your apps everywhere else. Change any of them in Settings › Shortcuts.

### RESIZE

| | |
|---|---|
| Vertical divider left / right | ⌃ ⌘ [ / ] |
| Horizontal divider up / down | ⌃ ⇧ ⌘ [ / ] |

### LAYOUT

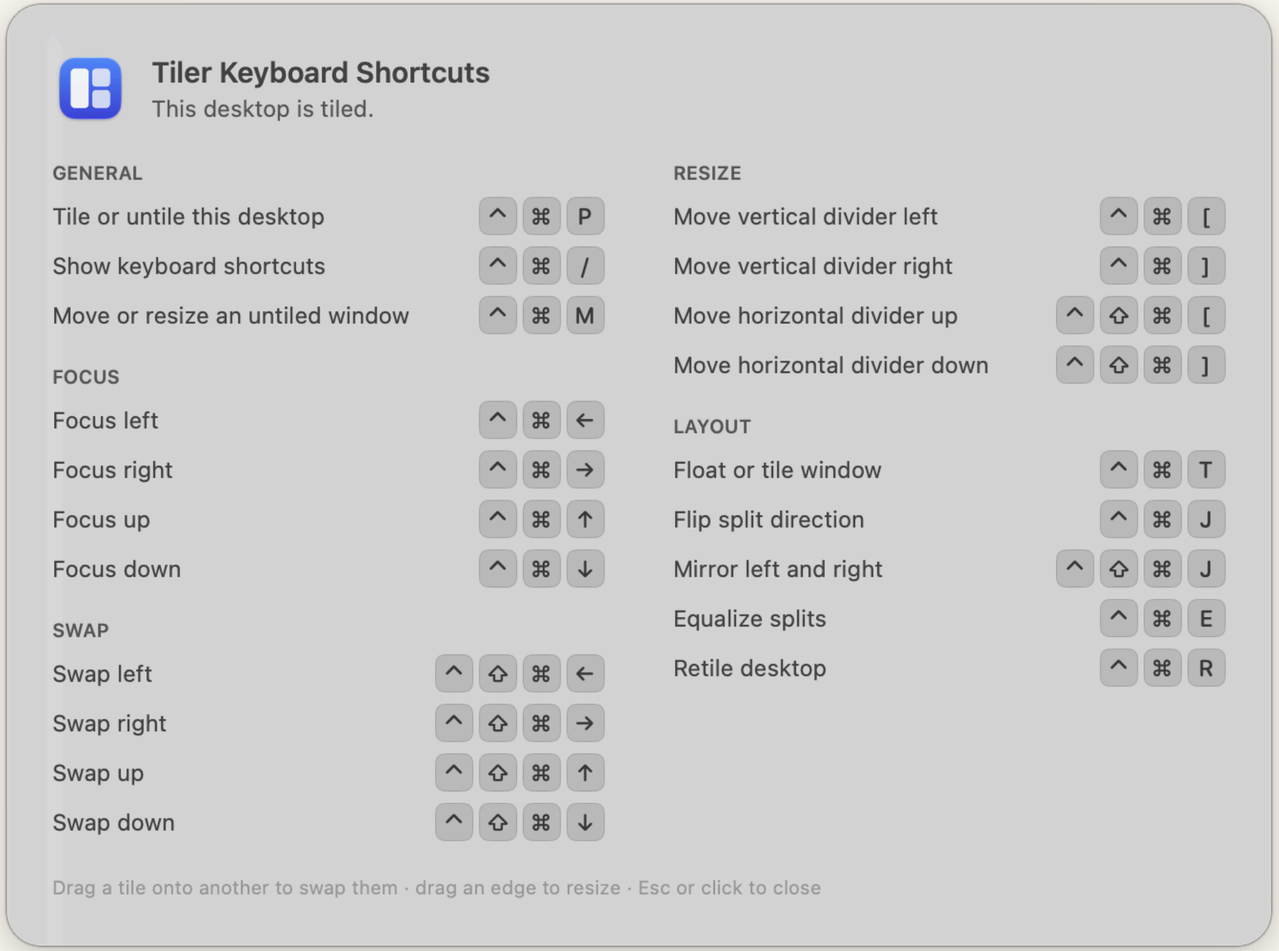
| | |
|---|---|
| Float or tile the window | ⌃ ⌘ T |
| Flip split (side by side ↔ stacked) | ⌃ ⌘ J |
| Mirror left ↔ right | ⌃ ⇧ ⌘ J |
| Equalize every split | ⌃ ⌘ E |
| Retile the desktop | ⌃ ⌘ R |

# Forgot a key? Press ^⌘/

A translucent panel lists every shortcut, grouped, on the display you're working on. It also works from the menu: **Keyboard Shortcuts**.

It never takes focus, so the app underneath keeps your keyboard and selection.

It closes on **Esc**, a click anywhere, a desktop switch, or the same shortcut again. On an untiled desktop the tiling rows are dimmed.



# Untiled windows, by keyboard.

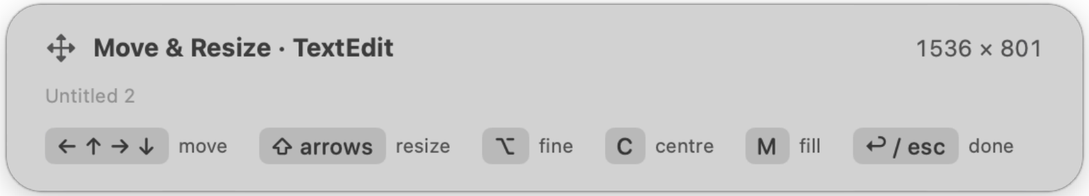
Press ⌃ ⌘ M (or menu › **Move or Resize Window**) and the window you're in can be moved and sized with the keyboard, until you press **Return** or **Esc**.

It works on any desktop, for any window Tiler isn't tiling: a floating window, or every window on an untiled desktop. A tiled window gets a short note to float it first with ⌃ ⌘ T.

The keys are only taken while the mode is on. Switching app or desktop, or a click, ends it too.

### WHILE THE MODE IS ON

| | |
|---|---|
| Move 40 pt | ← → ↑ ↓ |
| Resize (right/down grow) | ⇧ + ← → ↑ ↓ |
| Fine steps of 8 pt | ⌥ + arrows |
| Centre / fill the screen | C / M |
| Done | ↩ / esc / ⌃ ⌘ M |



# The mouse still works, and Tiler follows it.

01

## Drag onto a tile

Drop a window on another tile and the two swap places. Drop it anywhere else and it snaps back into its tile.

02

## Drag an edge

Resize a window by its edge and the split follows: the neighbour shrinks or grows to match, gaps stay even.

03

## Drop in, drag out

Move a window onto a tiled desktop and it joins the layout. Drag it to another display and Tiler lets it go.

**Float one window:** ^ ⌘ T takes it out of the layout and centres it at 60 % of the screen. Press again to tile it.

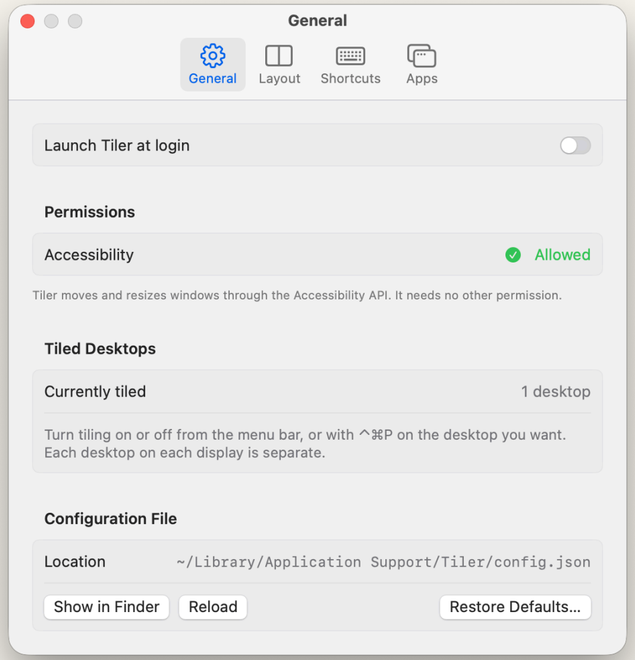
**Floats on its own:** dialogs, panels, non-resizable windows, and apps on the Always Float list (System Settings, Activity Monitor, Calculator by default).

# 03

# Make it yours.

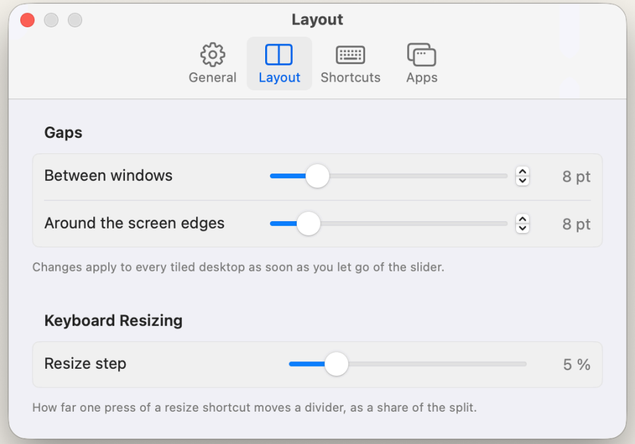
Settings…, from the menu or by opening Tiler again. Every change is saved and applied at once.

# General and Layout: startup, permission, gaps.




## General

- Launch Tiler at login
- Accessibility status
- How many desktops are tiled
- Config file: Show in Finder, Reload, Restore Defaults

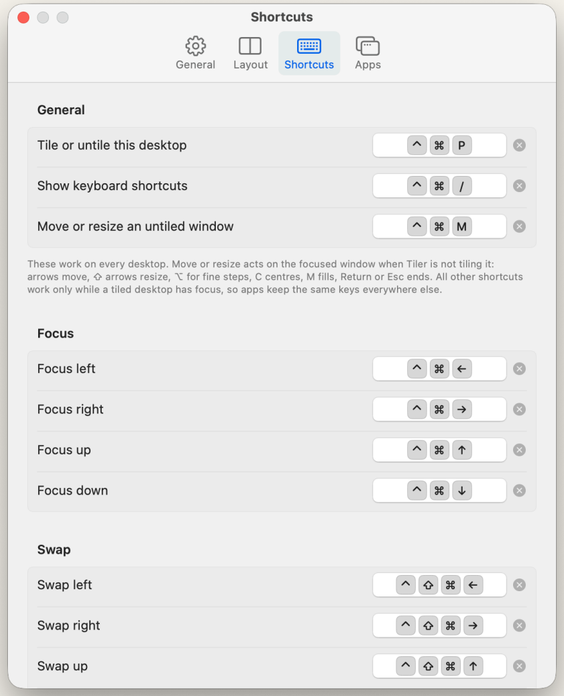



## Layout

- Gap between windows
- Gap at the screen edges
- Resize step per key press

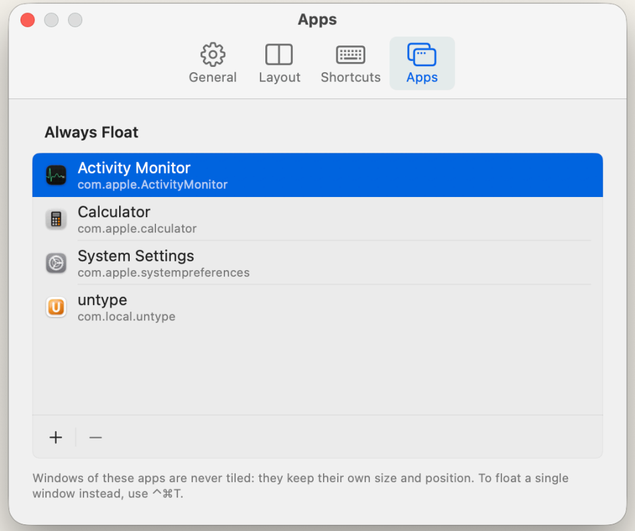
Applied to every tiled desktop when you let go of the slider.

# Shortcuts and Apps: your keys, your exceptions.




## Shortcuts

- Click a shortcut, press the new keys
- **Delete** clears it, **Esc** cancels
- A key already used by another action is refused, with its name
- Restore Defaults




## Apps

- Apps whose windows always float
- **+** picks a running app or one from Finder
- **−** removes the selected app

# The config file, a few limits, and how to leave.

01

## One config file

Settings writes `~/Library/Application Support/Tiler/config.json`. Prefer a text editor? Edit it, then Settings › General › Reload.

Every key is required. A mistake is shown in the menu and in Settings, which stays read-only until it's fixed or you Restore Defaults.

02

## Known limits

Apps with a minimum size (Outlook needs 770 pt) can overlap their neighbour on a small screen.

If another tool owns a key (Rectangle, Hammerspoon), it wins: pick another key in Settings. Don't tile the same desktop with HyprMac.

03

## Uninstall

`brew uninstall --cask tiler` removes the app and keeps your settings.

`brew uninstall --zap --cask tiler` also removes the config and the list of tiled desktops.

TRY IT TODAY

# Tile what you want.
# *Leave the rest alone.*

```
$ brew tap BikS2013/tiler
$ brew install --cask tiler
```

Source and releases

`github.com/BikS2013/tiler`

This deck and the engineering deck

`biks2013.github.io/tiler`

BikS2013

Tiler 0.3 · macOS 14+
Open source, MIT license · Swift, no dependencies